

Q **Dunhumby has been in India for about five years now. How much of change have you seen in Big Data analytics in the country, since you came into the business?**

Dunhumby has been into Big Data analytics for over 20 years now. Ever since we ventured into the Indian market, we have seen more and more talented individuals entering the field, who deliver better and better solutions. The other reality, which may be just specific to Dunhumby in India, is that we have found a big way of leveraging the scale and the talent that we have in India to impact our businesses in every single market and geography in the world. We have not looked at India as a way to automate or focus on some pre-defined processes. We have always looked at the Indian team to help us support every single business we have across the globe. To do so, we have created a really tight connection between our India team here and our clients worldwide. We are exposing the teams to the entire portfolio of solutions that we give to the customers. So our team in India is the biggest, and has some of the best experts in the business and in everything we do. For us, the biggest evolution in the past five years has been that we really found the unique way to leverage our team in India to deliver value everywhere in the world, as opposed to just doing things in a limited manner.

The Indian team members do everything that we do in other offices, despite the fact that we do not have any customers here. That is the key point. We have ensured that the team here is not limited to a certain scope of work. It is important that the team looks at everything we do, so that it can help us bring it to other markets. It is clearly a great opportunity to be engaged and exposed to everything, so that you can have a clear understanding of the whole cycle. We are talking to a few potential partners right now in the Indian market. The team here is pretty instrumental in doing that.

Q **What is your team size in India?**

About 230 people work for us in this country.

Q **Do you get the right kind of talent here or do you train them to suit your needs?**

Yes, this is probably the team that has been the most successful at getting great quality talent in a timely fashion on a consistent basis. I have been very impressed by the quality of talent we have been able to acquire in India. We have acquired talent from some of the local universities as well as from the industry. It has been a very successful journey for us as far as getting the right kind of talent and business is concerned.

Q **What kind of development processes do you have in India?**

The developers' team in India works on data. We are always looking to introduce new development opportunities in the country. We also have some corporate functions, where we look for opportunities and leverage some of the talent available here. In a global business like ours, we need to find ways of providing the best services we can to every client we engage with. And for that you need great talent and great

skills. Because of the unique position of our Indian team and our initial approach to it, the talent here is best qualified to do that work and deliver innovation and constant reinvention, whether it is on the technology front or on the corporate front. India is a fantastic market to engage with.

Q **Do you want to expand your footprint to the other parts of the country as well?**

When we initially established ourselves, Gurgaon was an apt location because the IT industry was growing here. So, we were naturally attracted to the place and were able to get the desired talent. People are even ready to migrate from places like Bengaluru, Hyderabad, et al. We may think of expanding to other cities if we have some partnerships. We get a lot of talent from Bengaluru, so that is the second city that naturally comes to our mind for expansion. But all that happens only when we have some definite partnerships in the country. In fact, we have recently expanded our Gurgaon office and have taken another floor.

Q **So with this new floor, do you plan to hire new talent?**

Yes. The whole intention of having a new floor in the building was to get more talent as we felt the need for it. We have had a very successful year as a team. So, we are looking at opportunities coming in for the Indian team and hence the expansion. We estimate that we will reach the 300 mark in terms of manpower by next year by hiring about 65 people this year. We are not worried about hiring great talent in India. We get plenty of it.

Q **You hire a lot of freshers, I understand?**

Actually, it is a mix of fresh and lateral hiring. We do concentrate on a lot of fresh hiring. On an average, we have 10-12 graduates who join us. Globally, Dunhumby believes in getting the fresh graduates in. It's a model that works very well for us. We also look for interns for shorter time periods, to see if they have future potential. We hire differently compared to the other firms. We don't look for just the skills but for a cultural fit as well.

Q **So what are the attributes a person must bring to the table in order to be hired at Dunhumby?**

We have some core values that we want in our employees, which become a very integral part of the DNA of the people working at Dunhumby. Employees should have passion, an ability for collaboration, curiosity and courage. There has to be a mutual understanding on both sides regarding what the company is about and what the core ethics of its value systems are.

Q **Do you think certifications add to one's profile when it comes to hiring at a place like Dunhumby?**

Certifications do add, but they can't be the basis of hiring. If we have a candidate who is certified in the technologies that we use, it is an added advantage. But, along with it, the candidate must have the other attributes as well. 